with Lashkari Bazar Group IX (see Gardin 1963: 135). Additionally, Taddei (1979: 910ff.) suggested that the similarity between the octagonal enclosure-platform of Mound A and the tomb known as Sultan Ghari in Delhi, dated to the 1230s CE, lend formal and circumstantial evidence for Shansabani dating and patronage of Tiginabad/Old Qandahar's Mound A (and possibly Mound B). The parallel with the later Sultan Ghari is also mentioned by Edwards (2015: 102).

94. Hephthalite burials in Afghanistan certainly provide comparable parallels to the excavated Tiginabad/Old Qandahar mounds, and with good reason, given the Rutbil command of the area well into the ninth century. It is also noteworthy that mound burials, or *kurghan*s, were quite different from urban burial practices and have been "associated with the nomadic nations of Central Asia"; some scholars have used the dissemination of *kurghan*s to trace movements of nomadic groups. Cf. Ball 1996: 400–401. But, cf. Hüttel and Erdenebat (2010: 4–5) on the study of Eurasian nomadic horsemen since the seventeenth century as essentially a one-sided "archaeology of graves … a cultural history … limited to the history of burial rituals …" desperately needing to be balanced with the archaeology of nomadic settlements for a "more authentic picture of the cultural scope and diversity of nomadic empires of the steppe …" See Chapter 5; and Volume II for the more orthodox Islamic burial and tomb of the later patriarch Sultan Ghiyath al-Din Muhammad (d. AH 599/1203 CE) in Herat.
95. In the context of the events unfolding in the 1160s–1170s, Juzjani vol. I, 1963: 396 (trans. vol. I, 1881: 448–449) had described Tiginabad as the largest city in *garm-sir*, as well as the pivot of the Ghaznavids' downfall when the Shansabanis captured it. Quite possibly, the Oghüz bands fleeing Saljuq reprisals in Khurasan only accelerated the gradual depopulation of the region (see *supra* in main text). Cf. also Bosworth [1977] 1992: 124–125. Thus, even Tiginabad might have appeared to be a large city in a region largely emptied of its inhabitants. Tiginabad could also be seen as the origin of the Yaminis' irreversible defeat, since it was from there that the Shansabanis launched successful operations against Ghazna itself.
96. Cf. Thomas 2018: 135–136; see also *supra* in main text and notes.
97. Cf. de Planhol [2000] 2012.
98. The family hierarchy was not without contestation, as is evident in the Bamiyan Shansabanis' adoption of royal titles on their coinage several decades prior to their official conferral – see Chapter 1.
99. Hüttel and Erdenebat 2010: 5.